

Rocco Nardo

COSC 481 Capstone

COSFE Website Redesign and Development Midterm Report

Overall Progress:

Throughout the first half of the semester, I have completed most of the work involved in migrating and designing content from the current COFSE site to a new site. I set up a Wix environment, created all the needed pages, transferred agreed upon content, and designed a clean and modern site using CSS by connecting the Wix site to GitHub and VS Code. I have also made major progress in implementing an online membership application, as I designed the form and inputs, created a Wix database for storing submissions, and created a triggered email that will be sent to administrators containing all the submitted information. In addition, while I have not worked on the implementation yet, I have done a large amount of research regarding Wix Payments and integrating Constant Contact to a Wix site, as well as discussed how I plan on integrating them with Dr. Ferrara. Lastly, although it was not an original objective, I have implemented and completed a Delta Delta Epsilon membership application form that stores submissions in a database and sends submissions to the DDE president for review.

Remaining Work:

While I have made progress on many objectives, there are still five objectives that must be completed. Even though I created and set up the COFSE membership application, I still need to develop functionality that will allow the administrators to approve or decline the application, where approval automatically makes the user a member. I also must

create the members-only page, implement an online payment option for members to pay dues, integrate an email communication platform like Constant Contact, and transfer the existing COFSE website domain to the new site. The remaining work is estimated to take around 5-6 weeks to complete.

Unanticipated Challenges:

Wix and Custom Control – My main challenge was fully understanding the amount of customization that Wix allows through custom code. I spent many hours conducting research to grasp what custom control Wix allows. For example, Wix requires that all elements and databases be created directly in their editor, and there is no way to gain access to the raw HTML files. However, through research and trial and error, I discovered I can write custom code to style each individual element one at a time with CSS, as well as create all backend files that give the site functionality.

Identifying and Accessing Updated Content – Throughout this process, there have been times where I have not been sure if content on the current site should be migrated over, as well as did not always have access to updated information and links. To ensure progress was still being made, I would always clarify and ask Dr. Ferrara if specific content should be migrated over. Also, when requesting access to updated information, Dr. Ferrara would reach out to the specific administrator responsible for the information to ensure I gain proper access.

Testing Limitations of an Unpublished Site – Since I have been working on an unpublished Wix site, there are certain features of my implementation that will be difficult to test. For example, it is challenging to verify whether email links work properly and if administrators

can successfully approve membership applications directly from an email. To address this, I plan on discussing with Dr. Ferrara the possibility of publishing the site a few weeks earlier than planned to give time to test and fix any bugs.

Objectives / Design Changes:

While developing the website, I have made minor changes to the design by adding pages that I originally did not plan on having. I added a dedicated page for each executive board member containing their picture and bio. I also separated the membership page into two, so the membership resources page appears as its own page in the navigation menu. I made these changes to make the site cleaner and easier to navigate. I also added a hidden admin review page that will allow administrators to directly accept or decline COFSE member applications through links sent to their email.

There were also several changes to the objectives. First, we added an objective for implementing a DDE application form that gets emailed to the DDE president. When going through each page of the current site, we realized that we originally overlooked the DDE related content, so we decided to add this objective. We also changed our plan for implementing a payment system. While we originally planned on linking to a PayPal account, we decided to attempt to use the Wix Payment feature instead, as it is more professional and provides more experience for myself. However, we decided to change the order of objectives by now planning on working on the Constant Contact implementation before the payment implementation. This was done as we feel that Constant Contact is more critical since Dr. Ferrara can easily add a PayPal link, as originally intended, if I do not have time to finish the payment implementation.

Contributions:

As I am the only student working on this project, I have worked on all the completed tasks with 100% of the effort. These include setting up the Wix site, migrating over the relevant information, designing the site with the Wix Editor and CSS, completing the DDE submission form, making major progress on the COFSE submission form, and researching for and planning the other agreed upon objectives. I have worked on this project for a total of **48.0 hours**, for an average of **8.0 hours** per week over the first six weeks of the development phase.

Future Work:

The next step in this process is completing the implementation of the administrator review process of the membership applications by developing code that automatically changes a user's authorization access to a member if they are approved. Once this is complete, I will work on creating the members-only page that will require members to log in with their email and password to verify they have been approved. Next, I plan on doing more research and begin to integrate the Constant Contact platform into the site so administrators can easily contact all members at once. Then I will use the Wix Payments feature to develop a method where members can pay their dues every year. Once all the features are implemented, I will transfer the domain name from the current site to new site and test all functionality. Lastly, I will create a training document that explains to administrators how to make changes and use the site, as well as a basic HTML document of the site I created. The HTML document will allow Dr. Ferrara to migrate away from Wix if needed, since Wix does not provide the source HTML.

Code Repository:

<https://github.com/rocco-nardoizzo/COFSE-Capstone.git>

Dr. Ferrara has approved of making the repository public as there is no proprietary information.

Work Log:

[CapstoneWorkLog - Copy.xlsx](#)